to socially include the poor in order to reduce poverty.

Financial inclusion refers to increasing broad-based access for approximately 2.7 billion poor adults to formal or semi-formal financial services ranging from banking to micro-credit to housing loans. In the wake of the 2008 crisis, itself triggered by financial inclusion strategies gone awry in the US and Europe, G20 leaders embraced financial inclusion as a core development strategy for overcoming the global recessionary environment.

The G20 Principles were drafted by the G20's Access Through Innovation Sub-Group and the Financial Inclusion Expert Group, which involved three key implementing partners – Alliance for Financial Inclusion (funded by the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation), the Consultative Group to Assist the Poor (CGAP), and the World Bank's International Finance Corporation. From this heady mix of pro-market 'experts', the Principles for Innovative Financial Inclusion were drafted and later approved by G20 leaders at the Summit in Seoul in 2010.

The G20 Principles entail a regulatory framework based on (individualised) responsibilisation and voluntary guidelines. The G20 Principles represent extensions of, as opposed to a departure from, the neoliberal development project. The Principles act to legitimate, normalise and consolidate the claims of powerful, transnational capital interests that benefit from the status quo.

The primary way this is achieved is through obscuring and concealing the exploitative relations and speculative tendencies involved in financial inclusion strategies. This trend, which is best described by David Harvey's notion of 'accumulation by dispossession', has also led to the growing dependence on, and increased vulnerability to, the volatile nature of global finance, which has been historically marked by speculation, panics and crises – all of which run counter to the aims of the pro-poor growth and poverty alleviation goals of the financial inclusion agenda.

A good example of the rise of speculative tendencies in global development is asset-backed securitisation (ABS). Securitisation describes a process of packaging individual loans and other debt instruments, transforming this package into a security or securities, and enhancing their credit status or rating to further their sale to third-party investors, such as mutual and pension funds. ABS began to increase dramatically in use in the US during the late 1990s before expanding to Europe and eventually to the South. In the wake of the litany of financial crises in emerging market economies in the late 1990s and the subsequent scarcity of low-cost, long-term loans, the IMF touted the virtues of securitisation as a means for private and public sector entities in the Global South to raise funds.

The ability of micro-finance institutions (MFIs), for instance, to turn to